

TEMPTATION

CRITIQUE

In this section, we put stuff through the grinder and closely examine what comes out; everything except gadgets, because there's more to life than just that

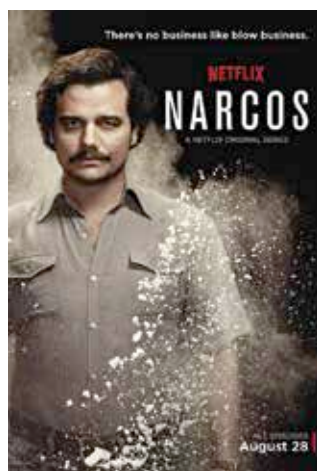
TV

Narcos

"Plata... o plomo?" - El Patrón

As a civil servant in Colombia during the reign of Pablo Escobar, the quote above could very well have been the last words you'd hear. His offer was all but an illusion of choice. You could either accept his bribe or be riddled with bullets.

Narcos is yet another feather in Netflix's cap which portrays the story of Pablo Escobar and his run-ins with the DEA. Pablo, who was known by a lot of monikers – one of which was The Tsar of Cocaine – was one of the most feared drug lords to have originated from Latin America and the seventh richest man in the world at his peak. Wagner



Moura's portrayal of Pablo Escobar truly does justice to the drug kingpin's persona – the way he dealt with family, friends, "associates" and enemies.

This isn't the first time Escobar's story hit the silver screen but it sure feels like one of, if not the best, retelling. We're hooked!

Rating: ★★★★★

- Mithun Mohandas

MOVIE REVIEW

The Martian

To the promised land... and back!

It's great to see so many movies around the science of space exploration in recent times. And The Martian is a great addition to that list. It captures humanity's innate fascination with our second closest celestial neighbour.

Matt Damon is at his charismatic best in this movie, far from his villainous tendencies which he so genuinely portrayed in Interstellar, another recent flick where he was left stranded on an alien planet. Jeez, get it together Matthew! Jessica Chastain is the commander of the mission that successfully lands on Mars. Its crew hastily retreats following what's best described as unscientific circumstances.

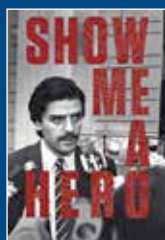
With my limited scientific knowledge, I just couldn't wrap my head around the kind of storm that Matt Damon and his crew experience within the first ten minutes of the movie. It just seems physically impossible. Then, at one point, Damon's character tries to seal his temporary Martian base with duct tape and plastic tarp. I mean, come on! The less said about the rescue mission the better, which was just too Evel Knievel to be honest. You expect audiences to believe that? Seriously?!



But that's about the only gripe I have with the movie, but that's okay as long as you don't go all Neil Degrasse Tyson on it. Because ultimately, the movie is daring and funny, but still cautious and optimistic at the same time. It simultaneously exposes some of the dangers of space travel and the potential of human ingenuity. For all of us who love Mars, adore Matt Damon, and even those interested about the human space program should indeed watch this movie. You'll have a lot of fun. Another reason to watch would be a certain actor who breaks the prolonged stereotype and doesn't die in the movie.

Rating: ★★★★★

- Jayesh Shinde



Show me a hero
Get a perspective of the dirty politics that go down within the power corridors of the US Senate as the mayor of Yonkers, New York fights for the desegregation of public housing.



Wicked City
Murder and romance go hand in hand for Kent Grainger and Betty Beaumontaine, but the LAPD is closing in fast on the couple. Would the LAPD catch them first or will the murdering spree continue unabated?



The Catch
After getting embezzled out of everything she owns, Detective Alice Vaughan is out to get even with her fiancé, who took everything away from her. Is she the hunter or the hunted? Catch the series to find out.